

Alternative Usages?

Q I have no DVD-ROM drive on my computer. However, I have a Philips DVD video player (DVD623K). Is there any way I can connect my Philips DVD to my computer and use it as a DVD-ROM?

Arindam Dutta Roy

A Unfortunately, you cannot. Even though your DVD player can read DVDs, its firmware (chip inside your DVD player) is not programmed to read data discs, only movie and MP3 files. Even if you can get your DVD drive to read data discs, there is no way you can connect it to your PC to pass on digital data.

Invalid Key—No Probs!

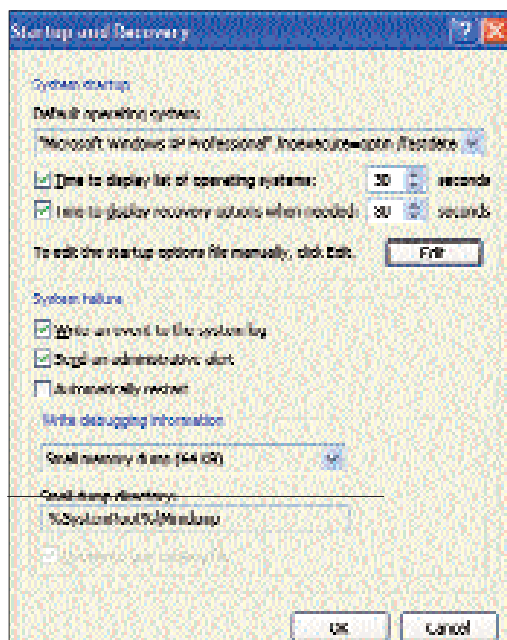
Q I recently created a Windows XP Professional SP2 bootable CD as described in *Take A Crack* in your March 2005 issue. My problem is that Setup accepts any Product Key, even blank spaces and semi-colons. Setup proceeds even when I keep the Product ID field empty and click 'Next'. And after the 'Get Updated Files' screen appears, it generates an error that says that the wizard cannot continue. What do I do about this?

Adarsh Akhilesh

A It looks as though either the Windows XP setup files you used or the CD that you created is corrupt. This could happen if the version of Windows XP you're using is pirated. We suggest you use the Windows XP setup files from the legal copy of Windows XP that you purchased. Also, try burning the CD at a lower speed such as 16X.

Seeing Double

Q I have Windows 98 SE and Windows XP Home Edition installed on my system. I formatted the



The Windows "Startup Options" dialog

drive that had XP on it and re-installed XP. Now, when Windows starts up, I get two Windows XP Home Edition names on the opening screen. How do I delete one of them?

Sanjairaj

A Since you had a dual-boot system, we assume you had Windows 98 SE on the C drive and Windows XP Home on, say, the D drive. A dual-boot system such as yours uses the Windows XP boot loader to boot. This is located on the C drive, and there is also the 'boot.ini' file, which resides in the root of this drive. The various operating systems that are installed and into which the system can boot are listed in this file.

When you reinstalled Windows XP over your previous installation, though the D drive was formatted, the C drive retained all its files, including boot.ini. This file is updated every time you install a new OS, and an entry for this OS is made. This file must be edited to correctly display just one instance of Windows XP Home Edition in the boot menu.

To edit boot.ini, in the Control Panel, open 'System'. Click on the 'Advanced' tab, and under the 'Startup and Recovery' section, click on 'Settings'. Under 'System Startup' in the newly-opened window, click 'Edit'. This will open the boot.ini in the default text editor. The structure of boot.ini will be something like this:

```
[boot loader]
timeout=30
default=multi(0)disk(0)rdisk(0)partition(2)\WINDOWS
[operating systems]
multi(0)disk(0)rdisk(0)partition(2)\WINDOWS="Microsoft Windows XP Home Edition" /fastdetect
multi(0)disk(0)rdisk(0)partition(2)\WINDOWS="Microsoft Windows XP Home Edition" /fastdetect
C:\="Windows"
```

As you might have noticed in the above, there is a duplicate entry for Windows XP Home Edition under the [operating systems] section. Just delete one of these two lines and save the file.

It is wise to back up boot.ini so if something goes wrong, you will be able to revert to the original settings.

Plug-N-Play?

Q Is there a device or connecting cable available in the market to connect a pen drive directly to a digicam?

Manoj Singhal

A An emerging standard in USB, known as USB 2.0 On-The-Go, enables any digital camera with a USB 2.0 interface to connect to a storage device that conforms to the standard. Devices that conform to this standard can directly connect to a digital camera, and images can be downloaded to the device.